



FEAB Partner Spotlight

Realities Focus INC

<https://www.makechangenoco.org>

Realities Focus INC provides year-round, free tax return preparation and education for low- and middle-income families, individuals and seniors. Their tax preparation and education services help the financially vulnerable avoid predatory service providers, while helping them improve their knowledge and personal financial capabilities.

SERVICES

They attend community programs in Fort Collins, Loveland and Windsor. Depending on the program, they may teach a mini clinic on topics such as starting an LLC, retirement withholding and planning, and how young people or newcomers to the US can prepare to file their first return. If they are not teaching a mini clinic, they set up a table and answer tax questions, help direct community members to services, and advertise their sites for filing assistance.

FINANCIAL SERVICES

Realities Focus INC prepares returns and answers questions within their knowledge about business expense tracking, financial planning, retirement questions, wage theft and the difference between contract and W-2 employees. If needed, they refer clients to services available in Northern Colorado such as legal aid, city programs, The Colorado Poverty Project and Neighbor to Neighbor. They also partner with FirstBank of Colorado who helps open Federal Bank on accounts.

TAXES

Realities Focus (Fort Collins VITA before 1990s) has partnered with The IRS to file income taxes through the VITA program since 1970. Currently, they have 3 sites in Fort Collins and 1 site in Windsor. They offer pop-up sites and homebound assistance as needed or available throughout the Fort Collins Area. They are the only site in Northern Colorado that assists foreign students and scholars. Off season, they continue to prepare tax returns, amendments, previous year filings and help clients understand tax notices from The IRS and Colorado. They average 50 volunteers during the filing season, 12 rotating year-round volunteers, and a board of 4. Their facility partners include Fort Collins Senior Center, Poudre Valley Libraries, Windsor Severence Library, Neighbor to Neighbor and Colorado State University. They average 3,000 federal and state filings per year.